

Leaf Mold



⚠ **Note :** Our AI helps quickly identify plant diseases, but it isn't 100% accurate. Results depend heavily on image quality—blurry photos can confuse the model. Always verify the final diagnosis with a qualified plant expert..

About disease and the symptoms

Leaf mold is a specific fungal disease caused by the fungus *Passalora fulva*. It is a sneaky pathogen that loves to show up when environmental conditions get highly specific.

This fungus thrives in environments with very high humidity (usually above 85%) and somewhat mild, warm temperatures. Because it relies heavily on still, damp air to produce and spread its tiny spores, it is especially notorious in places where air doesn't flow very well, like inside heavily crowded garden beds or enclosed growing spaces.

If you are inspecting your plants and suspect this fungus might be moving in, here is exactly how the disease progresses:

Upper Leaf Spots: The disease almost always begins on the older, lowest leaves. You will first notice pale, light yellow spots appearing on the upper surface of the foliage without any clear borders.

The Fuzzy Underside: This is the most telltale sign! If you flip that spotted leaf over, right underneath those yellow patches, you will find a distinct growth of velvety, olive-green or grayish-purple mold.

Curling and Drying: As the fungus takes over, those yellow spots merge together. The infected leaf will eventually start to curl upward, turn brown, and dry up completely before dropping off the plant.

Upward Spread: The disease starts near the soil line and steadily works its way upward as the spores catch the breeze and travel to the newer leaves.

Treatment

Treating leaf mold is all about eliminating the humid, stagnant environment where the fungus thrives, so start by gently removing and bagging any infected leaves to stop the microscopic spores from spreading. Next, radically improve your plant's air circulation by pruning away excess inner foliage and removing the bottommost branches, which helps the breeze blow right through the plant. It is absolutely crucial to keep the remaining leaves dry by strictly watering at the soil level rather than using overhead sprinklers. Finally, if you're growing in an enclosed space, immediately open vents to lower the humidity, and if the mold continues to spread, you can apply a protective organic fungicide (like copper or potassium bicarbonate) to shield the remaining healthy foliage from further infection.

